

TARU Interview Pack

Consent script · self-buyer, gifter and practitioner guides · notes template · outreach messages

Status: v1.0, 29 Sep 2026. Questions follow Appendix A of the brief word for word. Probes and laddering prompts are added in *italics*. Change question wording only after the pilot read, and log every change in the change log at the end.

1. Before every interview

Check

Participant ID assigned	Self-buyers B01–B05 · gifters B06–B09 · practitioners P01–P02
Consent script read, answer noted	Record “yes” or “notes only” in the notes template
Recording	Audio only, with consent. Stored in a private folder, never in the repo or Drive folder shared with anyone
Proof cards ready	P1 certification tag · P2 QR trail · P3 comfort guarantee (spec in the Survey Stimuli Spec)
Referral ask ready	End every buyer interview by asking for 3 people who could take the survey

Anonymisation rule (decision DL-03). Before any transcript or note goes into an AI tool, replace every name, employer, city area, family member’s name and identifying detail with a tag, e.g. [wife], [company], [Andheri → Mumbai suburb]. Keep the key that links IDs to people only on your own device, and delete it when the project ends.

2. Consent script (read aloud)

“Thank you for your time. I’m an MBA student at WeSchool doing an independent study on how men choose ethnic wear. It’s for a portfolio project about a fictional brand and isn’t connected to any company. It takes about 30 minutes and there are no right answers. May I record audio only, for accurate notes? The recording stays with me and is deleted after transcription, and nothing will be linked to your name. You can skip any question or stop at any time. Is that okay?”

If they decline recording: take written notes only and say so in the notes template.

3. Laddering: how to probe

Laddering moves from a **product attribute** to its **consequence** for the person, then to the **value** behind it. Keep asking until the answer is about the person, not the product. Usually 2–4 rounds.

Round	Prompt
Attribute – consequence	“Why does that matter to you?” · “What happens when it isn’t like that?”
Consequence – value	“And why is that important to you?” · “What does that let you do / feel?”
Stuck or circular	“Think of the last time it went wrong. What was that like?”
Stop when	The answer names a value (being present for family, dignity, respect, confidence, not being judged)

Worked example from the brief: *soft fabric* → *no itching during a 6-hour function* → *I can be present for my family*.

Do not suggest answers, name “organic” before question 5 (self-buyer) or question 4 (gifter), or react to answers positively or negatively.

4. Self-buyer guide (men aged 40–60, about 30 minutes)

1. Tell me about the last time you bought ethnic wear for yourself: the occasion, where, who else was involved, what you paid, and what nearly stopped you.
 - *Probe: Who had the final say? Did you try it on? Was it bought for one occasion or several?*
2. What do you look for in the fabric? Any bad experiences, such as itching, heat or fit?
Ladder: “Why does that matter?” and then “Why is that important to you?”
 - *Probe: How long do you usually wear it at a function? What happens by the end?*
3. How easy is it to find ethnic wear that fits you well? What do you do about fit?
 - *Probe: Do you use a tailor or alterations? Which sizes usually fail, and where (shoulders, belly, length)?*
4. Do you buy anything organic now, such as food or skincare? Why? How do you know it’s genuine?
 - *Probe: Have you ever doubted an organic claim? What made you doubt it?*
5. What would “organic” mean to you in clothing? Would it matter? Why or why not?
 - *Ladder the answer. Note whether the reason is personal (skin, comfort, health) or planet-focused.*
6. (Show the three proof cards.) Which would make you believe the claim? What would make you doubt it?

- *Probe each card: “What would you do with this, if anything?” For the QR card: “Would you actually scan it? When?”*
- *Ask for a ranking: most to least convincing.*
- 7. What would you expect to pay for an everyday kurta set? For a wedding-function set? At what point does it feel too expensive?
 - *Probe: Compared with what you usually pay, how much more would “certified organic” be worth, if anything?*
- 8. Where would you expect to find a brand like this? Would you buy ethnic wear online? What worries you about it?
 - *Probe: Fit, returns, fabric feel, paying in advance?*
- 9. Is there anything I should have asked?

Close: “Could you share the survey with 2–3 people who buy ethnic wear for themselves or for a father? I’ll send you the link.”

5. Gifter guide (ages 25–40, about 25 minutes)

1. Tell me about the last time you bought ethnic wear for your father or father-in-law: the occasion, why that piece, where, and the budget.
 - *Probe: Did he know? Did anyone else help choose?*
2. How do you decide what he’ll actually wear?
 - *Probe: Size, colour, fabric? Do you check with anyone?*
3. Has a clothing gift ever gone wrong? What happened?
 - *Ladder: “What did that feel like?” · “Why did it matter?”*
4. Would “certified organic” matter to you as the giver? To him? Why?
 - *Note separately: value to the giver (what the gift says about them) vs value to the wearer.*
5. (Show the proof cards.) Which would make you trust it as a gift?
 - *Probe: Would the proof be something you’d show him, or something only you’d see?*
6. What would you spend on a gift like this? What packaging or presentation would you expect?
7. Where would you buy it: online, in a store, or somewhere else?

Close: same referral ask as the self-buyer guide.

6. Practitioner guide (about 20 minutes)

Say before starting: “Please answer only about general industry practice. I’m not asking about your current or past employer’s confidential numbers, and I won’t record any.”

1. How do new apparel brands get listed in formats like yours?
2. What terms are typical in the industry: outright purchase vs sale-or-return, margin ranges, payment days?

- *Ask for ranges, not exact figures. Record as “practitioner-reported range” in the register (confidence M).*
- 3. What are the norms for returns and markdowns?
- 4. When does ethnic-wear stock need to land for the festive and wedding season?
- 5. What makes a new brand succeed or fail on the floor?
- 6. Would a certified-organic claim help sell-through? What proof would store staff need to sell it?

7. Store observation checklist (2 stores, as a shopper)

One Manyavar or Tasva store, one Fabindia store. **Observation only:** no recording, no staff interviews without consent.

Record	Store 1	Store 2
Date, city, format (mall / high street)		
Men's range split: everyday / festive / ceremonial (rough share of floor)		
Fabric labels: exact wording of any fibre or sustainability claim		
Price ladder: lowest, typical, highest kurta set (₹)		
Sizes displayed; anything for fuller builds		
Any organic, natural or eco claim, word for word		
Alteration or tailoring service offered		
What staff say unprompted about fabric (only if volunteered)		

8. Interview notes template (one per interview)

Field	Entry
ID	B__ / P__
Date, mode (in person / video / phone)	
Segment	Self-buyer · Gifter · Practitioner
Consent	Recorded / notes only

Field	Entry
Last purchase story (occasion, where, who decided, spend, near-blockers)	
Fabric and fit experiences	
Ladders (attribute → consequence → value), one line each	
What “organic” means to them; personal vs planet reason	
Proof-card ranking (P1/P2/P3) and reasons	
Price expectations: everyday set, wedding set, “too expensive” point	
Channel expectations and online worries	
Best verbatim quotes (anonymised)	
Surprises / anything that contradicts H1–H6	
Referrals given (count only, no names here)	

9. Outreach messages

Interview invite (WhatsApp / LinkedIn DM). Self-buyer version

Hello [name], I’m Anvesha, an MBA student at WeSchool. I’m doing an independent study on how men choose ethnic wear (kurtas, sets, Nehru jackets). It’s for a portfolio project about a fictional brand and isn’t linked to any company. Could I speak with you for about 30 minutes, in person or on a call, sometime this week? No preparation needed and nothing is linked to your name.

Interview invite. Gifter version

Hi [name], I’m doing an independent MBA study on how people choose ethnic wear as a gift for their father or father-in-law. If you’ve bought one in the last 2 years, could I speak with you for about 25 minutes this week? It’s for a portfolio project about a fictional brand, and it’s anonymous.

Ask to faculty, classmates and alumni for self-buyer referrals

I’m looking for men aged 40–60 who have bought ethnic wear for themselves in the last 2 years, for a 30-minute anonymous interview for my MBA study. If your father, an uncle or a colleague might be willing, could you ask them and share my number?

Survey recruitment post (LinkedIn), for when the form is live

I’m running an 8-minute anonymous survey for an independent MBA study on what makes clothing trustworthy.

Who it's for: - Men aged 40–60 who bought ethnic wear (kurta, set, Nehru jacket, sherwani) for themselves in the last 2 years - Anyone who bought ethnic wear for their father or father-in-law in the last 2 years

No names or contact details are collected. The study uses a fictional brand and isn't linked to any company. Results will be published here on [launch date].

Link: [survey link]

Sharing it with a parent or relative who fits helps most.

WhatsApp forward for family groups

Did you buy a kurta or ethnic set for yourself (men 40–60) or for your father in the last 2 years? My MBA study needs your view: 8 minutes, anonymous, on your phone. [survey link] Thank you!

10. Change log

Date	Item	Change	Reason
29 Sep 2026	All guides	Probes and laddering prompts added in italics; question wording unchanged	Brief 8.2 asks for laddering prompts